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31 JANUARY 1964
SUPERSEDING
MIL-E-8881(ASG)
3 SEPTEMBER 1959

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ENCLOSURE, ELECTROMAGNETIC-SHIELDING, DEMOUNTABLE, PREFABRICATED GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification has been approved by the Department of Defense and is mandatory for use by the Departments of the Army, the Navy, and the Air Force.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers shielding enclosures which provide specified degrees of attenuation of electromagnetic fields from 100 kilocycles (kc) to 20,000 megacycles (mc) for the purpose of test and alignment of electronic equipments and other related purposes.

1.2 Classification. Shielding enclosures shall be of the types listed in table I, as specified (see 6.2) :

TABLE I. Types of shielded enclosures

Type	Number of shields	Shielding material
Ia	Single shield	Screen-mesh or perforated metal
Ib	Single shield	Solid metal
IIa	Double shield, cell type	Screen-mesh or perforated metal
IIb	Double shield, cell type	Solid metal
IIIa	Double shield, isolated	Screen-mesh or perforated metal
IIIb	Double shield, isolated	Solid metal

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-S-571	- Solder; Lead Alloy, Tin Lead Alloy, and Tin Alloy; Flux Cored Ribbon and Wire, and Solid Form
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood

FSC 4940

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MIL-C-71	- Connectors, "N" for Radio Frequency Cables
MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of
MIL-C-132	- Crate, Wood, Open, Maximum Capacity 2,500 Pounds
MIL-C-3643	- Connectors, Coaxial, Radio Frequency, Series HN, and Associated Fittings, General Specification for
MIL-F-15733	- Filters, Radio Interference
MIL-E-17555	- Electronic and Electrical Equipment and Associated Repair Parts, Preparation for Delivery
MIL-P-18066	- Plywood, Ship and Boat Construction

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-8	- Dimensioning and Tolerancing
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of U.S Military Property
MIL-STD-220	- Method of Insertion-Loss Measurement for Radio-Frequency Filters
MIL-STD-285	- Attenuation Measurements for Enclosures, Electromagnetic Shielding, for Electronic Test Purposes, Method of

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

CONSOLIDATED CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE

Uniform Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies of the above publication should be addressed to the Consolidated Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Ill.)

AMERICAN TRUCKING ASSOCIATION, INC.

National Motor Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies of these freight classification rules should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Traffic Department, 1424 Sixteenth Street, N. W., Washington 6, D.C.)

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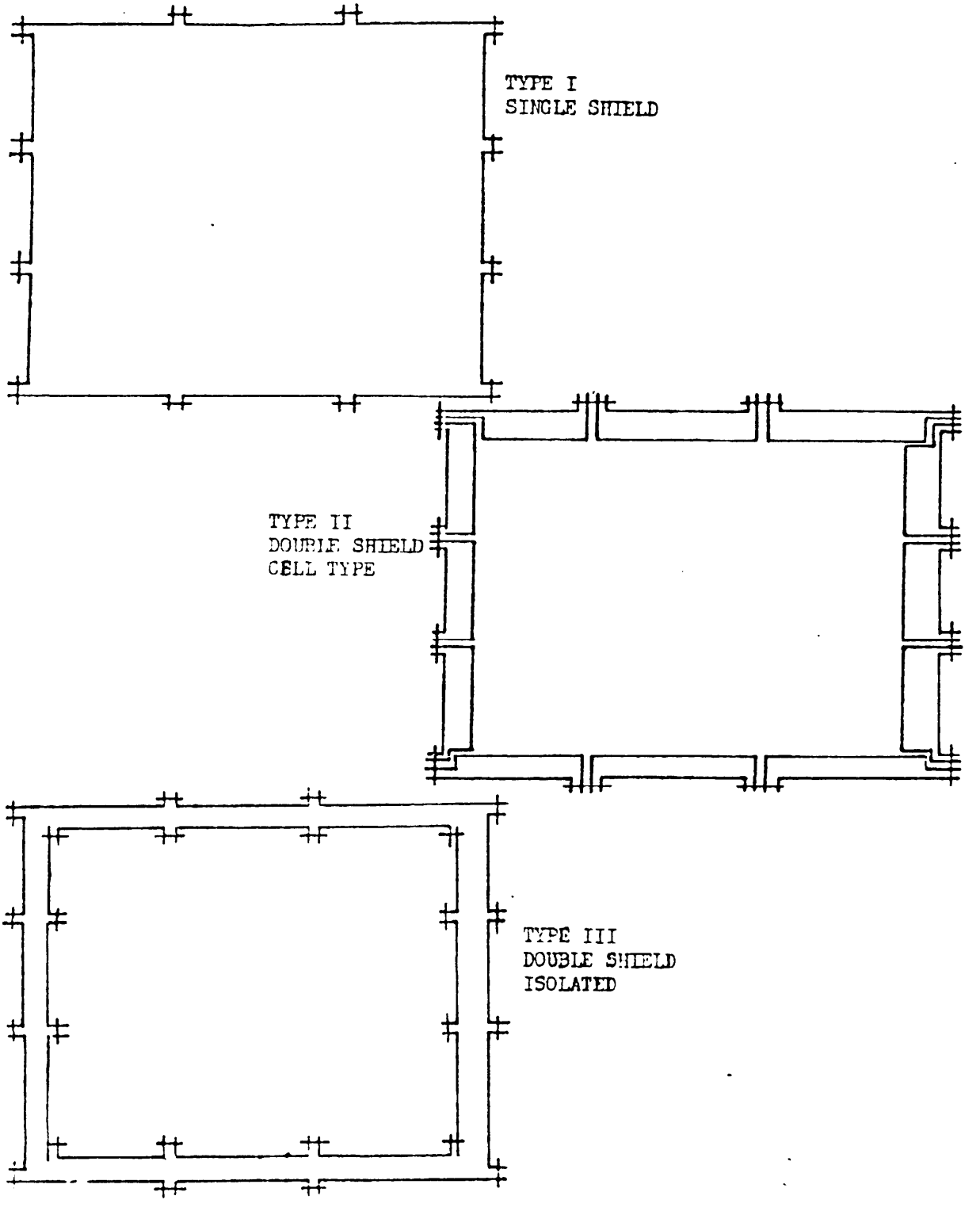


FIGURE 1. Illustration of basic construction of shielded enclosures

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction. This specification makes provisions for preproduction testing.

3.2 Basic construction and design. The shielding enclosure shall be demountable, prefabricated, and consist of several flat panels that can be assembled by use of bolts or clamps which can be placed inside or outside the enclosure. The completely assembled enclosure shall be a rigid body. A filter and connector panel shall contain all power line filters and transmission line connectors. An access panel shall provide a frame and door to the enclosure. The size and number of panels shall be varied to obtain the desired overall size of the enclosure. The basic construction shall be as illustrated on figure 1. For each type of shielded enclosure, the drawings giving design details, overall size, number of panels, thickness of shields, bill of materials, and specifications thereof, shall be designated or approved by the procuring activity.

3.2.1 This specification gives only the minimum construction and performance requirements for any type of shielded enclosures listed in table I, it does not specify any drawings giving complete design details.

3.2.2 Prior to the construction of the preproduction sample, the contractor shall submit all the drawings, bills of materials, and specifications thereof, giving the design details of the shielded enclosure for design approval by the procuring activity.

TABLE II. *Minimum attenuation design criteria for shielded enclosures*

Type of electromagnetic fields	Class and db of attenuation				
	A	B	C	D	E
Magnetic (100 kc to 30 mc)	30	40	70	76	82
Electric (100 kc to 30 mc)	110	120	140	190	220
Plane waves (30 mc to 1,000 mc)	60	70	100	220	240
Microwaves (1,000 to 10,000 mc)	35	50	[1]100	240	250

[1] Nominal attenuation. Varies from 70 to 130 decibels (db) due to the unavoidable deviations in the nominal distance separating the two shields.

Attenuations greater than 250 db are not listed as they represent the reduction down to 1 microvolt/meter (least discernible signal) from 3,160 kilovolts/meter (breakdown of free space).

The types of electromagnetic fields and frequency ranges considered are those that predominate in the vicinity of the enclosure at relatively high levels.

The attenuations in db listed for each class of attenuation take into consideration the deleterious effect on the shielding effectiveness of the enclosure introduced by the impedance at the seams between adjacent panels.

General information for the theory and calculation of the attenuation of shielded enclosures is given in the reference cited in 6.5.

3.3 Attenuation.

3.3.1 *Minimum attenuation design criteria.* The shielding effectiveness of the completely assembled enclosure with radio frequency (rf) coaxial connectors capped, line filters installed, and power fed into the enclosure, shall be designed for the minimum attenuation of one of the classes of attenuation given in table II. The class of attenuation shall be designated by the procuring activity.

3.3.1.1 *Choice of class of attenuation.* If the class of attenuation in table II is not designated by the procuring activity, class C shall be considered to apply. The attenuation provided by class C is adequate in most applications. Other classes may be designated and the choice depends on the magnitude of interference signals that may be present in the vicinity of the enclosure. General information for making the choice is given in 6.4.

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3.3.2 *Minimum attenuation test requirements*. When measurements cannot be made at the highest attenuations of table II, then they shall be made at least up to 120 db and also at the lower attenuations given therein. (Any defects in the enclosure will thus be readily detectable.)

3.4 **Minimum design and construction requirements.** The design details specified in 3.2 shall incorporate the following minimum design and construction requirements.

3.4.1 *Type and thickness of shielding materials and type of enclosure*. Several types of shielding materials, as listed below, in varying thicknesses may be used to meet the class of attenuation specified in 3.3.1. Substitute materials may be used if sample tests indicate that at least the same attenuation can be obtained for magnetic fields. These tests may be similar to those referenced in 6.6.

3.4.1.1 *Class A attenuation*. The enclosure shall be type Ia. The shielding material shall be commercial bronze window screening with an 18 by 14 mesh.

3.4.1.2 *Class B attenuation*. The enclosure shall be type Ia. The shielding material shall be either of the following:

(a) Screening 22-mesh, copper strands, at least 15 mils (0.015 inch) thick with a woof of hard-drawn and a warp of soft-annealed wire.

(b) Perforated copper sheets at least 15 mils in thickness with perforations evenly distributed and the distance between the periphery of adjacent perforations not less than 15 mils apart. Circular holes shall have a diameter not more than 37 mils. If square holes are used the side shall be not more than 32 mils.

3.4.1.3 *Class C attenuation*. One of the following three types of materials shall be used:

(a) Two sheets of screening material as indicated in 3.4.1.2(a). The enclosure shall be type IIa or type IIIa.

(b) Two sheets of perforated metal as indicated in 3.4.1.2(b). The enclosure shall be type IIa or type IIIa.

(c) One solid copper sheet of at least 18 mils in thickness. The enclosure shall be type Ib.

3.4.1.4 *Class D attenuation*. The enclosure shall be type Ib. The shielding material shall be a solid copper sheet at least 25 mils in thickness.

3.4.1.5 *Class E attenuation*. The enclosure shall be type IIb or type IIIb. The shielding material shall be 2 sheets of solid copper, each having a thickness of at least 10 mils.

3.4.2 *Separation of shields*. For enclosures using two shields, the distance between shields shall be sufficient to meet the performance specified.

3.4.3 *Securing of panels and width of seams*. Clamps or bolts fastening adjacent panels together shall be spaced 16 inches or closer, on centers. The width of lips shall be at least 1 inch for single-shielded enclosures and at least a 2-inch total for double-shielded enclosures. For the double-shielded isolated type enclosure, the width of each lip shall be at least 1 inch.

3.4.4 *Filter and connector panel*. One side panel designated as the "filter and connector panel" shall be provided with the following accessories.

3.4.4.1 *Power line filters*. Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, the following power line filters shall be supplied with the enclosure:

(a) One 28 volt, dc, 100 amperes

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(b) Two 115 volt, 60 cps, 50 amperes.

(c) Three 115 volt, 400 cps, 40 amperes, 3-phase.

The filters shall conform to MIL-F-15733 and be able to withstand a breakdown voltage of 500 volts, rms, 60 cps. All neutrals shall be tied together and connected to a common grounding stud on the panel.

3.4.4.1.1 If screen-mesh is used as the shielding material, the filter and connector panel shall be provided with a solid copper reinforcing plate for the installation of filters. This plate shall be soldered to the screen-mesh over its entire periphery.

3.4.4.1.2 One side of each filter shall be provided with a shield to give a minimum of 100 db decoupling between input and output. The filtered lines shall feed into the enclosure through solid metal pipes soldered to both shields and provided with threaded ends to facilitate capping when desired. For isolated wall design (type III) the shield shall be connected electrically at the fewest practicable number of points. All those points and pipes shall be placed as closely together as practicable, preferably on the same panel in order to approach one electrical contact of shield to shield.

3.4.4.1.3 The power line filters shall have a minimum insertion loss of 100 db from 100 kc to 20,000 mc. They shall be measured in accordance with MIL-STD-220 (see 6.6) from 100 kc to 1,000 mc. The measurements technique from 1 to 20 kilomegacycles (kmc) shall be as approved by the procuring activity.

3.4.4.2 *Rf connectors.* Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, in addition to the power line filters, the filter and connector panel shall be provided with the following rf coaxial connectors:

(a) Two type N assemblies in accordance with MIL-C-71. the receptacles on each end of these assemblies shall be equivalent to type UG-29B/U receptacles.

(b) One twin coaxial plug equivalent to type UG-493/U plug.

(c) Two type HN assemblies in accordance with MIL-C-3643. The receptacles on each end of these assemblies shall be equivalent to type IPC11050 receptacles.

3.4.4.2.1 All connectors shall be properly secured to the panel by means of hexagonal shaped nuts and then soldered to the shielding material on both shields. These connectors shall be provided with captive metal screw-on caps on each side of the panel.

3.4.5 *Plywood.* All plywood used shall be in accordance with class 1 or class 3 of MIL-P-18066.

3.4.6 *Access panel.* One side panel designated as the access panel shall incorporate a hinged door and door frame. The hinged door shall be provided with two sets of serrated phosphor-bronze fingers to insure continuity of shielding, and also three locks or notches that can be operated from both inside and outside of the shielded enclosure. The locks shall be equivalent to dog type, or better.

3.4.7 *Flooring.* Flooring sections shall be constructed as single sections of sufficient size to cover each floor-shielding panel. Each section shall be provided with recessed pull-rings at each end to insert fingers for removal and installation. The sections shall be of such size and fit that when placed in position inside the assembled shielding enclosure they will form a complete covering of the floor panel with minimum space between. When installed, the sections shall be even with the bottom surface of the entrance-panel aperture. Provisions shall be made to insure that the installation of the flooring sections does not damage the floor panels in any way.

3.4.7.1 The flooring sections shall be reinforced, as necessary, to provide a decking that will withstand a distributed floor loading of 150 pounds per square foot without damage or deformation.

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3.4.8 *Ventilation* Intake and exhaust openings for adequate ventilation shall be provided for enclosures using solid metal as the shielding material. Two panels shall incorporate metal grills, at least 1 square foot in area, consisting of waveguides having an attenuation of 100 db below 20,000 mc.

3.4.8.1 The ventilation grills shall be soldered to the solid metal panels along the entire periphery.

3.4.8.2 Blower or air conditioner units for use with the ventilation grills shall be supplied only on special order by the procuring activity.

3.5 Identification of product. Each panel shall be properly identified and marked to facilitate and insure proper assembly of the shielded enclosure. All marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship on all components of the shielding enclosure, including all parts and accessories, shall be in accordance with accepted standard practices for similar type construction.

3.6.1 *Tolerances.* Dimensions and tolerances not specified shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-8.

3.6.2 *Screw assemblies.* Assembly screws shall be tight. The word "tight" means that the screw cannot be appreciably tightened further without damage or injury to the screw threads, panel frames, or metal parts being assembled.

3.6.3 *Cleaning.* All components shall be thoroughly cleaned of metal chips and other foreign material after final assembly. All burrs, protrusions, and sharp edges shall be removed.

3.6.4 *Soldering.* All soldering shall be effected in a neat and workmanlike manner, and the surface surrounding the soldered connections shall be free from spatterings and excessive solder. Acid or corrosive flux shall not be employed There shall be no evidence of "cold soldering." Solder shall be soft solder, tin-lead, rosin-flux-cored in accordance with composition Sn50 of QQ-S-571.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of tests. The inspection and testing of shielding enclosures shall be classified as follows:

(a) Preproduction tests (4.3)
(b) Quality conformance tests (4.4)

4.3 Preproduction tests. The preproduction sample shall consist of one shielding enclosure representative of the production item and shall be tested in a place and manner designated in the contract, purchase order, or invitation for bids (see 6.2).

4.3.1 *Tests.* Preproduction tests shall consist of all the tests described under 4.5.

4.4 Quality conformance tests. One enclosure from each lot of 25 enclosures or fraction thereof shall be subjected to the tests described under 4.5.

4.5. Test methods.

4.5.1 *Examination of product* Each fabricated component and part shall be carefully examined to

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determine conformance with dimensions, materials, parts, workmanship and, in the case of an assembled enclosure, all fittings, mechanical joints, and ease of operation of all moveable parts.

4.5.2 *Measurement of attenuation.* Tests shall be made in accordance with MIL-STD-285 to determine compliance with the attenuation requirements of 3.3.2 expressed in db and listed in table II.

4.5.2.1 *Test frequencies.* The nominal test frequencies shall be as follows:

Magnetic fields - One frequency between 100 to 200 kc.

Electric fields - Three frequencies at 200 kc, 1 mc and 18 mc.

Plane waves - One frequency at 400 mc

Microwaves - One frequency at 10,000 mc.

4.5.3 *Preservation, packaging, and packing.* Preparation for delivery shall be examined for conformance to section 5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 *Level A.* Metal surfaces of component parts of the enclosure requiring the application of a contact preservative in accordance with MIL-P-116, shall be coated with type P-1 preservative in accordance with MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.1 *Fasteners and loose items.* Fasteners of like description such as bolts, nuts, washers, screws, nails, clips, and pins, and loose items shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with Method IC-3 or IC-5 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.1.2 *Electrical material.* Electrical components shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with MIL-E-17555.

5.1.1.3 *Technical publications.* Technical publications required for the enclosure shall be packaged in accordance with Method IC-3 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The complete enclosure shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the supplier's standard practice.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Levels A and B.* The enclosure, packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in crates conforming to MIL-C-132. Components, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be overpacked in containers conforming to style A or B, class 2 of PPP-B-601, and secured to the base of the crate to prevent shifting while in transit.

5.2.2 *Level C.* The complete enclosure shall be packed to insure arrival at destination in a satisfactory condition for acceptance by the carrier at the lowest rate. Containers shall conform to the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or the National Motor Freight Classification Rules, or with other carrier rules and regulations as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. Packages, bundles, and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

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6.1 Intended use. The shielding enclosures covered by this specification are intended to provide an interference-free enclosure for the operation, testing, and alignment of electronic equipments from 100 kc to 20,000 mc. The completely assembled enclosure is intended to attenuate electromagnetic fields from internal or external sources that cause undesirable interference with the test and alignment or operation of all types of electronic receivers

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Class of attenuation (see 3 3), overall size of enclosure, and approved drawings.

(c) Number of units in preproduction test sample if other than one, where the preproduction test sample should be sent, and instructions concerning the submittal of the test reports.

(d) Handbook requirements (see 6 3).

6.3 Handbook of service instructions. It is expected that the contract will specify the following:

(a) The handbook of service instructions will meet such requirements as the procuring activity may specify and will contain the following information.

(b) The handbook of service instructions will include specific instructions for mounting of 1/4-inch plywood panels on both inner and outer surfaces of the shielding panels in such manner as to preclude the possibility of a resulting decrease in the attenuation characteristics of the assembled enclosure. These panels will be provided by the using activity, to such height and on such sides as may be necessary to protect the shielding materials from mechanical damage.

(c) The handbook of service instructions will include specific instructions for the using activity to install the necessary power outlets and lighting fixtures without a resulting decrease to the attenuation characteristics of the shielding enclosure.

(d) The handbook of service instructions will include all necessary instructions on relocation, dismantling, allowed weight on top of room, handling of panels, cleaning of seams and erection, tightness, cleaning of the serrated access-panel fingers, repairs to serrated access-panel fingers, grounding plane of test tables, bonding, bonding jumpers, soldering, metallic objects penetrating the screens, reference ground, all service entrances, transmission-line connectors, fans, filters, decoupling filters, filter entry, attenuation of the shielding enclosure, leakage, use of the access panel, and such other items as may be specifically required by the applicable specification or the procuring activity.

(e) The handbook of service instructions will describe the satisfactory installation of circuit breakers and switches, both internal and external to the shielding enclosure.

(f) The handbook of service instructions will include illustrations of all phases of erection and disassembly of the complete shielding enclosure.

(g) Two handbooks of service instructions will accompany each complete shielding enclosure shipment, and this item shall be properly packaged and identified, in order that it will be readily available upon receipt by the procuring activity for use in installation of the shielding enclosure assembly.

(h) Data for design and mounting of shelves on the wall, and the permissible shelf loading.

(i) A specific value of torque which should be applied to bolts during assembly

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6.4 Criterion for degree of shielded effectiveness required. Several degrees of shielded effectiveness, listed in classes of attenuation, are given in table II. The criterion used to determine what degree or class of attenuation is required depends on the level of interference signals predominating in the vicinity of the enclosure. A guide for use in this criterion is given in table III.

TABLE III. *Guide for selecting required class of attenuation*

Interference signals to be suppressed	Class of Attenuation [1]
Electrical machinery, light, and power	A
Ignition, arc welding, diathermy, induction heating, and X-ray	B
Low power transmitters and radars, (up to 100 watts)	C
Medium power transmitters and radars, (100 watts to 100 kilowatts)	D
High power transmitters and radars, (100 kilowatts to 10 megawatts).	E

[1] The db of attenuation versus frequency for each class of attenuation is given in table II.

Interference signals from AM, FM, and TV stations, and high-tension power lines are remotely generated from the enclosures and any class of attenuation will be adequate suppression.

6.5 General information. General information regarding the theory, design characteristics, and test methods for shielded enclosures from 60 cycles per second to 10,000 mc may be found in Publication No. PB #121927 obtainable from the Department of Commerce, Office of Technical Services, Washington 25, D.C.

6.6 Test on samples of shielding materials. The details of tests to determine if equal attenuations are provided by substituting shielding materials may be in accordance with those outlined in the Naval Research Laboratory Report No. 4103, "A Technique for Measuring the Effectiveness of Various Shielding," H. E. Dinger and J. E. Radenbush, dated 22 January 1953.

6.7 Variations. The procuring activity will consider for approval any of the variations of design details that may be developed by industry at a later date as the state of the shielding art progresses.

6.8 Marginal indicia. The margins of this specification have been marked to indicate where changes, deletions, or additions from the previous issue have been made. This has been done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content as written, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
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	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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